

One-on-One with Scott McMichael

Date: Thursday, August 27, 2026 | 2:00 PM CT (19:00–19:30 UTC) | Microsoft Teams

Prepared for: David O'Hara

Before You Dial In — Two Things to Do Right Now

[ACTION — Do before 2 PM] Read the July 2026 U.S. Enterprise Scorecard Summary that Scott sent on Aug 20. You haven't read it yet. Scott sent it to Curtis Hite and the leadership group. You will want to know what's in it before Scott brings it up. File subject: "U.S. Enterprise Scorecard Summary, JULY 2026 Close."

[ACTION — Prepare your answer] Scott asked on Aug 13 whether you're still on the Account Plan with Wendy's. He hasn't heard back. This is now 14 days without a response from you. Have a specific, concrete answer ready before the call — yes you're on it, no you're off it, here's the status.

Summary of Interactions (Aug 13 – Aug 27, 2026)

The past two weeks with Scott have been active and wide-ranging. Three distinct threads are running simultaneously: an org-level shift (Pat Emmons departure), a set of open questions from Scott that still need answers from David (Wendy's, Monday.com, Vegas expense), and a stream of strategic material Scott is pushing David's way (Fractional CIO contacts, McKinsey gen AI article, Capital & Culture Summit intel). The tone is collegial and engaged — Scott is reaching out frequently. The risk is that David has several open asks from Scott that have not been closed out, which creates an impression of dropped balls in a relationship where follow-through matters.

Wendy's Account Plan — Open Question Since Aug 13

Scott emailed on Aug 13: "*David — Can you confirm specifically whether you're still on the Account Plan with Wendy's? Not sure where you left off with Don, but — as I recall — you were the main 'Executive...'*". This is an open, unambiguous ask for a status update. As of today (Aug 27), no response has been logged.

Context from the July 14 brief: Wendy's International was one of the three largest Dallas accounts, running behind pace at \$1.13M H1 against a \$2.34M H1 target (24% of 2025 FY revenue through mid-year). Scott's question suggests he has visibility into account activity and is checking whether the RD executive relationship with Wendy's is being maintained. David needs to answer this directly on the call if he hasn't already done so in writing.

Current state: Open — David owes Scott an answer. 14 days elapsed.

Pat Emmons Departure (Aug 24)

Scott announced to the executive group on Aug 24 that Pat Emmons is leaving Improving. The message acknowledged Pat's impact: "*He has made a significant impact on our business...*" This is an org-level event that likely has downstream implications for leadership coverage, accounts, or team structure depending on Pat's scope. Expect Scott to raise this, discuss transition planning, or simply check in on how David is thinking about the gap.

Current state: Announcement made. No follow-up thread. Be prepared to speak to implications for One Texas or your region if relevant.

Monday.com / AI Productivity Tools — Open Question Since Aug 6

In the "Expense Things..." thread on Aug 6, Scott asked: *"Have you and Devlin spoken about Monday.com as a part of AI productivity tool?"* This sits alongside the McKinsey gen AI article Scott shared that same week ("20x productivity" framing). The Monday.com question is now three weeks old. If you've had that conversation with Devlin, tell Scott. If you haven't, that's worth addressing — this appears to be a strategic question Scott is tracking, not a throwaway.

Current state: *Open — no response documented. 21 days elapsed.*

Vegas Trip / Expense Clarification — Aug 6

Scott asked: *"Is there a business trip to Vegas that is NOT retreat?"* He followed up with clarification that reimbursements come as a group from Dawn and Susan. Whether this was fully resolved isn't clear from the thread. If the expense question is settled, no action needed — but confirm mentally before the call so you're not caught off guard if Scott references it.

Current state: Likely resolved (Scott provided the reimbursement process), but verify.

Fractional CIO Contacts — Forwarded by Scott (Aug 13 & 16)

Scott connected David with two Fractional CIO contacts in back-to-back weeks:

Aug 13: Robert Hendricks (Valuzzia, former senior executive) — David replied Aug 14 and accepted the intro. A call prep brief for this meeting was built on Aug 21.

Aug 16: Another Fractional CIO contact forwarded to David.

Scott is actively building David's network. Worth acknowledging — a brief update on where the Hendricks conversation went (the Aug 21 call) would show Scott his energy is landing.

Current state: Robert Hendricks call happened Aug 21 (prep brief exists). Update Scott on the outcome.

McKinsey / Gen AI Strategic Thread (Aug 6)

Scott shared a McKinsey article about gen AI as the "killer application" in software development, explicitly connecting it to the "20x productivity" messaging Improving has been using. Scott is aligning leadership around a specific narrative. The Monday.com question sits in the same frame: Scott is thinking about AI productivity tools at an ops level and thought leadership at a market level simultaneously. David should be prepared to speak to how One Texas is applying this narrative in client conversations or pursuits.

Company Bookings Context — Strong Month (Aug 27)

Bryan Crawford's update this morning puts August bookings at \$14M+ with 3 business days left — up 23.6% YoY through Aug 24 at \$9.3M. Scott is almost certainly aware. If the July scorecard shows Q3 momentum, Scott may come in with energy around this. Be ready to connect One Texas's August performance to the broader company trajectory.

Previous One-on-One — July 14, 2026

The July 14 meeting was a structured H1 Review. Key themes still live:

Revenue behind target: One Texas H1 at \$16.75M, -11% vs. target. Dallas at threshold, Houston critical (-24%). Wendy's flagged at 24% pace.

No new anchor accounts closed H1: Pipeline active (AT&T, CBRE, Builders First Source, Tenet, TI in Dallas; Marriott, Kirby, Expedia, Masimo, Constellation in Houston) but none crossed the line.

Billable RD issue raised: July brief flagged this as a structural problem needing a guard-rails conversation with Scott. Status of that conversation: unknown.

Co-sell pipeline gap: \$5.6M tracked against \$15M target at Q2 close.

Executive Sales program deferred: Not yet launched as of July 14.

None of these are formally closed. The August call is an opportunity to give Scott an H2 progress update.

Open Action Items & Commitments

Item	Owner	Status	Source
Answer Scott's Wendy's account plan question	David	Overdue (14 days)	Email Aug 13
Update Scott on Robert Hendricks / Fractional CIO call outcome	David	Open	Email Aug 13-16, brief Aug 21
Clarify Monday.com / Devlin conversation	David	Overdue (21 days)	Email Aug 6
Confirm Vegas expense resolution	David	Likely resolved	Email Aug 6-8
Read July 2026 Enterprise Scorecard (before call)	David	Open — unread	Email Aug 20
H2 progress update: anchor account pipeline	David	No update documented	July 14 carryover
H2 progress update: co-sell pipeline toward \$15M	David	No update documented	July 14 carryover
Billable RD guard rails conversation	David / Scott	Status unknown	July 14 carryover
Executive Sales program launch	David	Deferred — no update	July 14 carryover

Key Calendar Events — Next 2 Weeks

(Excluding routine recurring meetings)

Thursday, August 27

One-on-One Scott McMichael (2:00 PM CT) — This meeting. 30 minutes. Teams.

Wednesday, September 3

AI Sovereignty Webinar — Scott Poulin — Improving-hosted. Signals the continued internal drumbeat on AI. David may want to reference this in the gen AI conversation with Scott today.

Tuesday, September 16

Capital & Culture Summit begins (Trilith, Sept 16-18) — Scott expressed interest on Aug 11. Vishal Biyani also presenting on Platform Engineering + Agents Sept 16. Confirm with Scott today whether he or David are attending.

Suggested Talking Points

1. Wendy's Account Plan — close this open loop first.

Scott asked 14 days ago. Before anything else, give him a direct answer: are you on the Account Plan with Wendy's, what's your executive relationship with the account, and where does it stand in H2? This matters because Wendy's was behind pace at H1 close (\$1.13M against a \$2.34M H1 target) and Scott is tracking it. Don't wait for him to bring it up — lead with it.

2. August bookings momentum — connect One Texas to the company story.

Company-wide bookings are hitting \$14M+ this month, up 23.6% YoY. What's the One Texas contribution to August? If it's strong, claim it. If it's mixed, give him the honest picture and what's moving in Q4. Scott has the July scorecard — he'll want to know how August is tracking by market.

3. Pat Emmons departure — your take and any implications for One Texas.

Scott made the announcement Aug 24. Come with a view: what does this mean for the org, for any accounts or regions Pat touched, and is there anything you're watching in One Texas as a result? Even if the answer is 'no direct impact,' showing you've thought about it signals leadership awareness.

4. Robert Hendricks call update — close the loop on Scott's introductions.

Scott sent two Fractional CIO contacts in two weeks. Show him that investment landed. Give him a 2-sentence update on the Hendricks call (Aug 21) — what came out of it, is there a next step. Scott sponsors relationships that produce outcomes; this is an opportunity to reinforce that.

5. Monday.com / AI productivity tools — answer Scott's question.

He asked Aug 6 whether you and Devlin have spoken. Three weeks have passed. If the answer is yes, tell him what the conversation produced. If the answer is no, tell him why and what you're planning. Scott is tracking this as part of a broader gen AI productivity narrative — it connects to the McKinsey piece he shared. Don't let this sit another week.

6. H2 anchor account pipeline — give Scott a progress signal.

The July 14 brief was explicit: no new anchors closed H1, pipeline active across both markets. Scott knows this. Give him a Q3 update: which pursuits have moved, which have stalled, and what you're doing differently in H2. If AT&T, CBRE, or any of the Houston targets have progressed, name them specifically.

7. Billable RD question — surface it if it hasn't been resolved.

The July 14 brief flagged this as a structural issue that needed a conversation with Scott. If that conversation happened and produced clarity, great — this is off the table. If it didn't, this call is the right moment. The question is simple: what are the guard rails around David being used in a billable capacity, and who owns the decision when a request comes in? Scott needs to hear this from David directly.